

Officers and men of 4 HORSE (Hodson's Horse) outside Phillora police station, September 1965. One of the lead regiments of 1 Armoured Division that attacked Phillora, 4 HORSE was equipped with British Centurion main battle tanks while Pakistan had newly acquired and technologically superior American Patton main battle tanks. Undeterred by the odds against it, 4 HORSE fought valiantly to capture Phillora on 11 September. (ADGPI/Public Domain)

On the night of 8/9 September, Pakistan's 4 Armoured Brigade tried to outflank the position to the north, but 4 GRENADIERS successfully withstood their attempts. Company Quartermaster Havildar Abdul Hamid alone destroyed two tanks and damaged one in this battle. Another outflanking move conducted by Pakistan's 4 CAVALRY from the north on the Mahmoodpura–Dibbipura axis also failed, as the well-sited Indian Army armour regiments trapped them on three sides. Pakistan lost 97 tanks including 72 Pattons in the battle of Asal Uttar. Indian forces made attempts